

MOST HAPPENING, FACT-FILLED CURRENT AFFAIRS FROM AROUND THE WORLD

Powerful microbatteries that charge phone in seconds

Researchers at University of Illinois claim to have developed the “most powerful battery on the planet.” “Though the microbatteries are only a few millimeters in size, yet they pack such a punch that a driver could use a cell phone powered by these batteries to jump-start a dead car battery – and then recharge the phone in the blink of an eye,” according to a report.

These new microbatteries are capable of out-powering even the best supercapacitors. They can help in driving new applications in radio communications and compact electronics.

Japan's next supercomputer will be 100x faster than K

After making the world's famous supercomputer K, Japan is now planning to develop the next-generation supercomputer by 2020. The sources say that Japan is looking forward to create a supercomputer that will be 100 times faster than K.

As reported by The Japan Times, officials from the Education, Culture, Sports, Science and Technology Ministry said that the government will seek funding for the design of the new machine in its fiscal 2015 budget.

According to the officials, the ministry hopes that this next-gen supercomputer would be used for the development of medicines and enhancement of disaster prevention by excellent prediction of earthquakes and tsunamis.

A robot that can assemble IKEA furniture

A team of scientists from MIT's Distributed Robotics Laboratory unveiled a robot at the IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA) that can assemble IKEA furniture on its own. The team calls it



MIT's IKEAbot

IKEAbot. The robot is equipped with a specialised gripper hand to grab the pieces of furniture and assemble them without any human help.

All you need to do is to provide instructions to the robot through CAD file about the product (such as number of pieces, number of holes, dimensions etc). You need not even instruct the robot how to go about it. The software can immediately interpret how something needs to be arranged.

Here comes BeagleBone Black PC board at \$45

BeagleBone Black was first heard in 2008, when the Texas Instruments' ARM-powered device was launched. Compared to the previous model, the BeagleBone Black comes packed with a 1GHz Sitara AM335x ARM Cortex-A8 processor.

In comparison to Raspberry Pi (priced at \$35), the BeagleBone Black costs \$10 more as it comes bundled with power supply and network cable.

The BeagleBone runs Ubuntu or other Linux distributions as well as Android. It can be used to build robots and electronics projects.

Mango Pi: A revolutionary PIC development board

For budding engineers, here's a perfect PIC development board. The board is developed and tested by EFY Lab and is available exclusively through Kits'n'Spares and their partners.

A PIC development board allows you to perform any experiment on PIC microcontrollers and create any application based on them with the minimum amount of effort and time.

Its easy and fast programming helps debug the programs at a much faster rate, reducing the time-to-market, whereas onboard interfaces like LCD and LEDs make it really comfortable to test the programs on the go. Connection of any external hardware is also very handy with I/O extended through box headers.

New development kit to print electrical circuits instantly

Methode Development Company (MDC) has launched an improved development kit enabling engineers to create functional electrical circuits with a piezo electric printhead inkjet desktop printer. This process not only eliminates tooling but also reduces the development time.